TrustHarvest

Hackathon pitch script with coaching notes

HackJos 2026 | Theme: Market Access & Value Chains, with Agri-Finance & Inclusion

How to use this: read the green box aloud (that is your script). The yellow box explains why it works and how to deliver it. The whole pitch runs about 3 minutes plus a 1 minute live demo. Practise it out loud twice and you will sound natural.

The pitch at a glance

Part	Time	Goal
1. Hook	0:20	Make them feel the problem
2. Problem	0:30	Show who loses and why
3. Solution	0:30	One sentence, then three features
4. Live demo	1:00	Prove it works
5. Why our team	0:20	Show you can finish it
6. Business model	0:20	Show it can survive
7. Next steps and ask	0:20	End strong

Golden rules

- Be honest that payments are simulated. Judges respect honesty and punish bluffing.
- Do not quote statistics unless you can name the source. A confident true story beats a shaky number.
- Speak slowly, pause after the hook, and look at the judges, not the screen.
- Everyone on the team speaks for at least one part. It shows you work as a team.

1. The hook

0:00 to 0:20

WHAT TO SAY

Imagine you spent four months growing tomatoes in Jos. You load the truck, the buyer takes it, and says, "I will pay you tomorrow." Tomorrow comes. Then next week. Then the phone goes off. Four months of work, gone. This is not rare. This is a normal week for many farmers. And we built the fix.

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Open with a story, not your name. Stories make judges lean in. Pause for two seconds after "gone". Say it as if it happened to someone you know. Change "tomatoes in Jos" to a crop and place that fits your own story if you have one.

2. The problem

0:20 to 0:50

WHAT TO SAY

Farmers do not trust buyers they do not know, and buyers do not trust sellers they cannot verify. So both fall back on middlemen, who take a large cut and add delay. The farmer earns less, the buyer pays more, and the money that should reach the farm gets lost on the way. Without trust, the market cannot grow.

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Name both sides of the problem: farmers get cheated and buyers get scammed. That shows you understand the whole market, which matches the theme "Market Access and Value Chains". Avoid blaming anyone. Keep it about missing trust, not bad people.

3. The solution

0:50 to 1:20

WHAT TO SAY

TrustHarvest is a trust layer for farm produce. It does three things. First, escrow: the buyer pays, and the money is held safely until delivery is confirmed. Second, verified profiles, so you know who you are trading with. Third, a trust score that grows with every completed trade, which also gives farmers a financial history that lenders can use later. Pay safely, deliver, get paid.

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Give the one-sentence version first ("a trust layer for farm produce"), then exactly three features. Judges remember threes. The trust score line connects you to the Agri-Finance and Inclusion theme without extra slides. Hold up three fingers as you count.

4. Live demo (1:00 to 2:00)

Open the app on your phone or a phone-sized window. Have two logins ready: buyer 0803000003 and farmer 0803000001 (password pass1234).

- **Land on the hero.** "This is what a farmer sees first." Let the slideshow show one or two slides.
- **Log in as the buyer.** Open the market, point at the photos and the Verified badge and trust score on a listing.
- **Buy with escrow.** Buy 2 baskets of tomatoes. Say: "The money has left my wallet, but the farmer has not received it yet. It is held in escrow."
- **Switch to the farmer.** Open Orders and tap Mark as delivered.
- **Switch back to the buyer.** Tap Confirm delivery. Say: "Now the money is released, and both trust scores go up."
- **Show the safety net (cyber teammate).** Open the admin Fraud tab and audit log: "Every status change is recorded, and suspicious accounts get flagged."

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Rehearse the demo at least three times so the clicks are automatic. Keep the farmer logged in on a second browser window so you do not waste time on logins. Narrate what you do while you do it. If something breaks, stay calm, say "this is why we are glad we built an audit log", and move to the next step. Have a short screen recording ready as a backup in case Wi-Fi fails.

5. Why our team

2:00 to 2:20

WHAT TO SAY

We are a team of designers, a backend engineer and a cybersecurity specialist, and that mix is on purpose. Our designers made an interface that farmers with little experience can use. Our backend engineer built the escrow logic. And our security specialist built the fraud flags and audit trail, because a product that holds money must earn trust first.

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Each teammate says their own sentence. This answers the unspoken question "can this team actually finish it?". The security point is your edge: most teams cannot credibly talk about protecting money.

6. Business model

2:20 to 2:40

WHAT TO SAY

We would charge a small fee on each completed trade, paid from the escrow. Farmers pay nothing to join, and they only pay when they actually get paid. As trade volume grows, we can partner with lenders and cooperatives who value the trust history we build.

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Keep it simple and believable. Do not promise revenue numbers. If judges ask for the exact percentage, say you would test it with early users, which is the honest answer.

7. Next steps and the ask

2:40 to 3:00

WHAT TO SAY

Today, payments and identity checks are simulated for the demo. Next, we integrate a real payment provider such as Paystack or Flutterwave, add NIN or BVN verification, and make it work over SMS and USSD for farmers without smartphones. We would love to pilot with a farmers cooperative in Plateau State. TrustHarvest: so every farmer who grows the food gets paid for it. Thank you.

WHY THIS WORKS / HOW TO DELIVER IT

Saying clearly what is simulated builds credibility. Ending with a specific ask (a pilot with a cooperative) is stronger than "thank you". Finish with your closing line, then stop talking and smile.

Questions judges may ask, and honest answers

"Is the payment real?"
No. For the hackathon the wallet and escrow are simulated so we could prove the full flow. The next step is a licensed payment provider such as Paystack or Flutterwave, which handles the real money movement.

"What if the buyer and farmer disagree?"
The order moves to Disputed and the funds stay held. An admin reviews it and either pays the farmer or refunds the buyer, and the dispute is recorded in the audit log and on both trust scores.

"How do you stop fake accounts?"
We use verified profiles, rate limiting, hashed passwords and fraud flags for repeated disputes. Real identity checks with NIN or BVN are the next step.

"Farmers do not all have smartphones."
Correct, which is why SMS and USSD access is on our roadmap. The interface is already designed with large buttons and simple wording for low-literacy use.

"Who are your competitors?"
There are agri marketplaces and general payment apps. Our focus is trust: escrow plus a trust history built from real trades, designed for farmers rather than retail shoppers. (Name one or two real competitors you have checked before you present.)

"How will you make money?"
A small fee on completed trades. We would validate the right level in a pilot.

Before you present

- Charge your phone and laptop, and bring a charger.
- Run **npm install** and **npm start** an hour early, then reset by deleting data.json for fresh demo data.
- Record a 60 second backup video of the full demo.
- Decide who says what, and time yourselves with a phone stopwatch.
- Photo credits: confirm the licence for each photo you used and credit the photographers in the footer.
- Drink water, breathe, and remember that the judges want you to do well.

You built something real in a short time. Go sleep, and good luck at HackJos 2026.